Updated: 24 August 2026

Garrett L. Grainger

Manchester Metropolitan University
Policy Evaluation and Research Unit
Department of Sociology
Email: g.grainger@mmu.ac.uk
Website: linkedin.com/in/glgrainger/

Geoffrey Manton Building
Rosamond Street West
Manchester
M15 6LL
United Kingdom

Academic Appointments

2026–2027	Research Associate, Policy Evaluation and Research Unit (PERU), Department of Sociology, Manchester Metropolitan University
2024–2027	Research Fellow in Social Inclusion, Cyfiawnder: Social Inclusion Research Institute, Wrexham University.
2023–2025	Research Associate & Associate Lecturer, Policy Evaluation and Research Unit (PERU), Department of Sociology, Manchester Metropolitan University.
2021–2022	Research Associate, UK Collaborative Centre for Housing Evidence, Department of Urban Studies, University of Glasgow.

Education

MA.	Higher Education, Manchester Metropolitan University *Distinction*	2026
MSc.	Spatial Planning and Real Estate Development, Heriot-Watt University *Distinction*	2023
PhD.	Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison	2021
MSc.	Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison	2013
BSc.	Psychology, University of Central Florida Minors: Statistics, Sociology, Political Science	2010

Certificates

Postgraduate Certificate of Learning in Higher Education, Manchester Metropolitan University. *Distinction*	2024
HMIS Data Analytics On-Demand Course, U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development.	2024

Advanced GIS Capstone Certificate, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Department of Geography. 2022

Skills

Analysis: MAXQDA | NVivo | STATA | SQL | Python | ArcGIS | QGIS
Cartography: ArcMap | Mapbox
Design: Illustrator | Photoshop
Development: HTML | CSS

Areas of Interest

Social Theory | Governance | Social Policy | Homelessness | Sustainable Development | Placemaking | Quantitative & Qualitative Methods | Cartography | Data Visualisation

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Grainger, Garrett L. et al.. 2025. "Implementing a Social Investment Pilot for Homelessness in England." *European Journal on Homelessness* 19(2): 141–166

Grainger, Garrett L. 2024. **"**What Barriers Do Administrators Face Whilst Upgrading their Data Assemblage." *Housing Studies,* pp. 1–24. doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2024.2416966

**Valerie Karn Prize, Highly Commended Paper of the Year, Housing Studies Association 2015.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2024. "How Should Policymakers Import Built for Zero to Different Countries?" *Housing and Society*, pp. 1–9. https://doi.org/10.1080/08882746.2024.2419771

Grainger, Garrett L. 2024. "What Benefits Do Homeless Systems Get from By-Name Data?" *Journal of Social Distress and Homelessness*, pp. 1–13. https://doi.org/10.1080/10530789.2024.2411862

Grainger, Garrett L. 2024. "How Waitlist Management Affects Data Production in Built for Zero Communities." *International Journal on Homelessness*. https://doi.org/10.5206/ijoh.2023.3.17541

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "Draining a Flooded Bathtub: A Qualitative Analysis of Built for Zero Implementation During COVID-19." *Housing and Society.* https://doi.org/10.1080/08882746.2023.2276610

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "How Do Housing First Caseworkers Mediate Landlord-Tenant Conflicts?" *Housing, Theory and Society.* http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/14036096.2023.2268637

Grainger, Garrett L. and Erin Gaede. 2023. "Making BIPOC Lives Matter: A Qualitative Analysis of Managerial Resistance to Racial Exclusions in US Homeless Systems." *Housing, Theory and Society.* http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/14036096.2023.2254770

Grainger, Garrett L. 2022. "What Tradeoffs are Made on the Path to Functional Zero Chronic Homelessness?" *Housing Studies.* https://doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2022.2141203

Grainger, Garrett L. 2022. "Seeing Like a Shadow State: An Ethnographic Analysis of Homeless Street Outreach in the USA." *Urban Geography.* https://doi.org/10.1080/02723638.2022.2093051

Grainger, Garrett L. 2021. "Discipline and Inclusively Repress: The Hybrid Governance of Housing First Tenants." *Housing, Theory and Society.* https://doi.org/10.1080/14036096.2021.2012251

Grainger, Garrett L. 2021. "Punishment, Support, and/or Discipline? Taking Stock of Recent Debates About Homeless Governance in Neoliberal Cities." *Sociology Compass.* https://doi.org/10.1111/soc4.12909

Grainger, Garrett L. 2021. "Yielding Returns on Social Investment Through the Micro-Economisation of Housing First Recipients." *Sociological Inquiry* 92(S1): 967–993. https://doi.org/10.1111/soin.12430

Grainger, Garrett L. 2020. "'It's Not a Pattern of Behaviour': Proxy Deflection of Eviction Stigma by Community Care Providers." *Symbolic Interaction* 44(3): 479–503. https://doi.org/10.1002/symb.511

Mahutga, Matthew C., Roy Kwon, and Garrett L. Grainger. 2011. "Within-Country Inequality and the Modern World-System: A Theoretical Reprise and Empirical First Step." *Journal of World Systems Research* 17: 279–307. https://doi.org/10.5195/jwsr.2011.417

Under Review

Grainger, Garrett L. 2026. "Does Built for Zero Enhance the Performance of Homelessness Systems?" *Journal of Social Distress and Homelessness*.

Professional Reports

Grainger, Garrett L., Kevin Albertson, Christopher Fox, Ben Hall, Kenneth Gibb, Suzanne Fitzpatrick, and Chris O'Leary. 2026. "Everyone In: Final Impact Report." Policy Evaluation and Research Unit.

Sanders, Ben, Suzanne Fitzpatrick, Francesca Albanese, Alex Marsh, and Garrett L. Grainger. 2025. "Moving the Deck Chairs? Social Housing Allocations in England." Crisis UK.

Grainger, Garrett L., Kevin Albertson, Christopher Fox, Ben Hall, Kenneth Gibb, Suzanne Fitzpatrick, and Chris O'Leary. 2025. "Everyone In: Early Impact Report." Policy Evaluation and Research Unit.

Grainger, Garrett L., Kevin Albertson, Christopher Fox, Ben Hall, Kenneth Gibb, Suzanne Fitzpatrick, and Chris O'Leary. 2024. "Everyone In: Implementation Report." Policy Evaluation and Research Unit.

Grainger, Garrett L., Alex Marsh, and Kenneth Gibb. 2023. "Taking Stock of Strategic Foresight in the UK Social Housing Sector." UK Collaborative Centre for Housing Evidence.

Blogs, Op-eds, & Media Appearances

Grainger, Garrett L. 2026. "'Trying to Keep Our Head Above Water': Congress Must Prepare to Keep Homeless Service Providers Afloat Next Year." *Shelterforce.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2026. "Utah Housing Model is Wrong Way to Go." *The Progressive.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2026. "'A Grim March Toward Death:' What HUD's New Homeless Policy Looks Like on the Ground." *Shelterforce.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2026. "Conservatives Must Clarify their Plan for 'Stronger Borders.'" LSE British Politics and Policy Blog.

Grainger, Garrett L. 2026. "HUD Is Throwing Local Homeless Systems into Chaos." *The Progressive.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2026. "A Tech Bro Think Tank is Trying to Roll Back Evidence-Based Homeless Policy." *Truthout.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2025. "State Governors Must Act Now to Prevent Mass Homelessness." *The Hill.*

Grainger, Garrett L., and Christopher Fox. 2025. "New Evidence Suggests Social Investment Financing Can Help End Homelessness." *Inside Housing.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2024. "How Thurston County is Aiming to Bring Homelessness to 'Functional Zero.'" *NPR.*

Grainger, Garrett L. 2024. "Five Questions Housing Analysts Should Ask About 'By-Name Data.'" Housing Studies Association.

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "How Do Housing First Caseworkers Lease-up Clients?" Housing Studies Association.

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "Sunak's Rhetoric on Climate Action May Embolden Britain's Far-Right." LSE British Politics and Policy Blog.

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "15-Minute Prisons? A Reflection on the Far-Right Backlash Against Sustainable Development in Britain." *Metropolitics*.

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "Racial Equity Demands Bespoke Homeless Assessments." Housing Studies Association.

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "Celebrate Pride Month in Scotland by Ending LGBT Homelessness." UK Collaborative Centre for Housing Evidence.

Grainger, Garrett L. 2022. "Housing First is Not Enough." *Contexts*. https://doi.org/10.1177/15365042221107667

Acar, Taylan, Robert Chiles, Garrett Grainger, Aliza Luft, Rahul Mahajan, João Peschanski, Chelsea Shelly, Jason Turowetz, and Ian F. Wall. 2011. "Inside the Wisconsin Occupation." *Contexts* 10(3): 50–55. https://doi.org/10.1177/1536504211418455

Book Reviews

Grainger, Garrett L. 2025. "The Male Complaint: The Manosphere and Misogyny Online." *Sociological Forum*. https://doi.org/10.1111/socf.70008

Grainger, Garrett L. 2024. "Sociology of Housing: How Homes Shape Our Social Lives." *Housing and Society*. https://doi.org/10.1080/08882746.2024.2309067

Grainger, Garrett L. 2023. "Homelessness and Housing Advocacy: The Role of Red-Tape Warriors." *Housing Studies* 39(1): 1–3. https://doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2023.2278857

Invited Guest Lectures

February 2024. "Understanding Bivariate Analyses." Department of Sociology and Criminology, Manchester Metropolitan University.

December 2023. "The Digital Poorhouse." Department of Sociology and Criminology, Manchester Metropolitan University.

November 2023. "Policing Homelessness." Department of Sociology and Criminology, Manchester Metropolitan University.

April 2022. "Homeless Policy in the USA." Department of Planning and Landscape Architecture, University of Wisconsin-Madison.

April 2017. "Urban Homelessness in the USA." Department of Community and Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison.

Conference Presentations

Grainger, Garrett L. "Learning from Sabotage: Negative Case Studies and the Case for Relational Public Services." Relational Public Services Conference. June 2026.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Area Deprivation has a Paradoxical Relationship with Homeless Pathways.” Housing Studies Association. April 2026.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Implementing a Social Investment Pilot for Homelessness in England.” Housing Studies Association. April 2026.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Does Built for Zero Enhance the Performance of Homeless Systems?” Relational Public Services Conference. June 2025.

Grainger, Garrett L. “What Barriers Do Administrators Face Whilst Upgrading their Data Assemblage?” Housing Studies Association. April 2025.

Grainger, Garrett L. “How Do Housing First Caseworkers Mediate Landlord-Tenant Conflicts?” Housing Studies Association. April 2024.

Grainger, Garrett L. “It is Already Happening Here: Rethinking Sustainable Development in the Era of Far-Right Populism.” British Sociological Association 2024 Conference. April 2024.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Making BIPOC Lives Matter: A Qualitative Analysis of Managerial Resistance to Racial Exclusions in US Homeless Systems.” British Sociological Association 2023 Conference. April 2023.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Seeing Like a Shadow State: An Ethnographic Analysis of Biopolitical Interventions by Homeless Street Outreach Workers.” British Sociological Association 2022 Virtual Conference. April 2022.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Managing Eviction’s Fallout: The Missing Organizational Dimension.” Eastern Sociological Society 2019 Meeting, Boston, MA, March 2019.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Integration through Segregation: Limitations of Master Lease PSH to Housing First Implementation.” Midwest Sociological Society 2019, Chicago, IL, April 2019.

Grainger, Garrett L. “From Applicant to Client: People-Processing in the Continuum of Care Program.” 2018 APPAM Annual Conference, Washington, D.C., November 2018.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Who is the “99%”: Collective Identity Management in a Left Populist Cross-Movement Coalition.” Southern Sociological Society, New Orleans, LA, April 2018.

Grainger, Garrett L. “Navigating the Courthouse: Negotiating Social Identities While Conducting Focused Ethnography,” Midwest Law and Society Retreat, Madison, WI, October 2014.

Fellowships, Scholarships, & Grants

2024. Conference Travel Award, Manchester Metropolitan University. (£500)

2022. Saltire Scholarship, Heriot-Watt University, The Urban Institute. (£8,500)

2022. Merit-based Fellowship, Heriot-Watt University. (£1,500)

2022. Early Career Research Support Fund, University of Glasgow School of Social and Political Science. (£2,500)

2019. Mellon-Wisconsin Fellowship, University of Wisconsin-Madison Graduate School. ($14,500)

2019. CROWE Scholarship Dissertation Improvement Award, Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin. ($3,000)

2018. Institute for Research on Poverty. Summer Graduate Research Fellow, University of Wisconsin-Madison. ($14,500)

2018. Advanced Opportunity Fellowship, Summer Research Fellow, University of Wisconsin-Madison. ($14,500)

2017. DeLamater Award, Department of Sociology, University of Wisconsin. ($3,000)

2017. CROWE Scholarship Travel Award, Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin. ($1,500)

2016. Conference Travel Award, Midwest Sociological Association. ($150)

2010. Advanced Opportunity Fellowship, University of Wisconsin-Madison. ($205,000)

Honours & Awards

2024. Teaching Fellow, Advance HE.

2023. The Royal Town Planning Institute Prize for Top Postgraduate Student, Heriot-Watt University, The Urban Institute.

2023. The Scottish Town & Country Planning Award for Best Postgraduate Dissertation, Heriot-Watt University, The Urban Institute.

2021. Magna Cum Laude, University of Wisconsin-Madison.

2010. Summa Cum Laude, University of Central Florida.

2010. Honors in the Major, University of Central Florida.

2010. Honourable Mention. Showcase of Undergraduate Research Excellence, University of Central Florida.

2010. Founder's Day Award for Excellence in Academic Performance, University of Central Florida.

2009. Mentoring Summer Research Internship Program, University of California, Riverside.

2008. Ronald E. McNair Post-Baccalaureate Achievement Program, University of Central Florida.

2008. UCF Scholars Award, University of Central Florida.

Academic Service

2024–Present. British Sociological Association, Early-Career Forum Convenor.

2023–Present. Housing and Society, Associate Editor.

2022. University of Glasgow, Thesis Supervisor.

2022. University of Glasgow, Ethics Committee Application Reviewer.

2022. British Sociological Association, Conference Section Chair.

2022. University of Glasgow, Thesis Writing Mentor.

2021–Present. Peer-Reviewer: *Sociological Inquiry (1); Journal of Contemporary Ethnography (2); Symbolic Interaction (1); Housing and Society (4); Housing, Theory and Society (2); Housing Studies (1); City & Community (1); Social Problems (1); International Journal on Homelessness (1).*

Professional Memberships

2023–Present. Housing Studies Association.

2022–2023. American Sociological Association.

2021–Present. British Sociological Association.

2021–2022. European Sociological Association.

References

Prof. Christopher Fox
Department of Sociology and Criminology
Manchester Metropolitan University
C.Fox@mmu.ac.uk

Prof. Suzanne Fitzpatrick

Director of I-SPHERE
Heriot-Watt University
s.fitzpatrick@hw.ac.uk

Dr. Mark Ellison
Associate Head of Department
Manchester Metropolitan University
M.Ellison@mmu.ac.uk

Dr. Daniel Joseph
Senior Lecturer
Manchester Metropolitan University
D.Joseph@mmu.ac.uk